

▷ COASTAL TREASURE

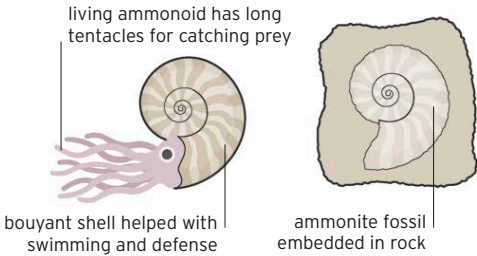
The species of ammonoid fossilized in this rock specimen lived 195 million years ago. Called *Promicroceras*, its fossils are very common in parts of the Jurassic Coast.

limestone
groundmass



WHAT ARE AMMONITES?

The rock strata of the Jurassic Coast are especially rich in ammonites—spiral-shaped fossils of the shells of extinct sea creatures called ammonoids. These predatory mollusks, alive 200-70 million years ago, were swimming organisms whose soft parts somewhat resembled those of present-day squids.



The **rock layers** of the Jurassic Coast cover **187 million years of Earth's history**